



Basque in the glory: Real Sociedad won its fourth Copa del Rey title, beating Atletico Madrid on penalties after a 2-2 draw in regulation time. AP

whipped in a free kick past Neuer before Harry Kane responded with a trademark finish. But that lead too was short-lived, as Kylian Mbappe joined the party to meet a Vinicius Jr pass to cap off an exhilarating half of football.

The chaos subsided after the restart until Eduardo Camavinga was sent off for deliberately delaying play just four minutes from regulation time. Sensing the opportunity, Bayern's wingers Luis Diaz and Michael Olise struck from the edge of the box to put the tie to bed.

With one Spanish giant eliminated, another was shown the door by Atletico Madrid, which produced a resilient performance to knock out Barcelona. Leading by two goals at the start of the second leg, Diego Simeone's men saw their advantage disappear quickly, with Lamine Yamal and Ferran Torres breaching the defence. However, new signing Ademola Lookman continued his bright start in Madrid by restoring Atletico's lead, which it held to extend Barcelona's European trophy drought to nearly 11 years.

Atletico will face Arsenal in the semifinal after the Gunners relied on Kai Havertz's stoppage-time strike in the first leg to edge past Sporting CP.

Meanwhile, reigning champion Paris Saint-Germain eliminated Liverpool for the second year in a row with 2-0 wins both home and away to set up a heavyweight clash against Bayern.

Copa del Rey

When Real Sociedad beat Athletic Bilbao to lift the Copa del Rey in 2021 (delayed 2020 edition), the COVID-19 pandemic kept its supporters away from witnessing the triumph.

However, five years on, the club made up for it by clinching the trophy again, this time beating Atletico Madrid on penalties in front of a packed La Cartuja stadium in Seville.

It was a speedy start from the Basque side as Ander Barrenetxea gave it the lead after just 14 seconds.

Lookman brought Atletico back on level terms before Mikel Oyarzabal converted a penalty — just as he did in 2021 against Bilbao — to restore the lead.

With seven minutes of regulation time left, Atletico's star man, Julian Alvarez, fired home the equaliser, forcing extra time and, eventually, a penalty shootout.

With everything on the line, Sociedad's custodian Unai Marrero stepped up, saving attempts from Alexander Sorloth and Alvarez before Pablo Marin sealed his side's fourth title, while Atletico's wait since 2013 continued.

Bundesliga

Anyone who has followed the German top tier this season would have known it was only a matter of time before Bayern wrapped up the league before moving on to bigger trophies.

And it came soon enough, as the Bavarians secured their 13th title in the last 14 seasons



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